

Nalepa 2010 RG Notes

Nalepa. *Skeletons in the Closet: Transitional Justice in Post-Communist Europe*.

New York: Cambridge University Press, 2010.

1 Main Idea

2 General Notes

- Differentiating why some post-USSR democracies pursued lustration, the discovery/vetting/exposure of those who were collaborators with the secret police, while others did not (or only did to varying extents)
- Game theoretic conclusion – lustration depends on politicians' private incentives to oppose lustration on the grounds of their own previous transgressions (i.e., the skeletons in the closet)
- Those without skeletons stand to gain normatively and politically from pursuing lustration, including in future political races or discussions
- Previous literature suggests this should just be in line with a party's previous support for communism; work shows that this is not the case

3 Important Specific Factual Claims

- Motivating instance is the bargaining over transition of power, primarily as it stands to significantly influence whether or not documents/materials are kept or destroyed

4 Connections

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5 My Critiques

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